oakleaf PARTNERSHIP

- Your trusted partner for over 21 years
- realpeOPle

Weil

CAREER INSIGHTS SESSION

Making your next move

Presented by

Beth Hicks / Director, Oakleaf Partnership

Marie Robery-Bliss / Director, Oakleaf Partnership

12 NOVEMBER 2026 · **OAKLEAFPARTNERSHIP.COM**

21

YEARS

Your trusted partner in HR recruitment and executive search

HR RECRUITMENT · EXECUTIVE SEARCH · INTERIM

WHO WE ARE

Oakleaf Partnership

A market leading boutique HR recruitment and executive search business. We combine deep subject matter and market expertise with a global client base across multiple industry sectors.

21 years

Of successful delivery in partnership with clients across multiple industry sectors.

UK and US

Offices in London and New York, with consultants who know their sectors and talent pools in depth.

Trust first

We care deeply about the people we serve and the relationships we build, founded on trust, confidentiality and delivery.

UK HR MARKET UPDATE · JULY TO SEPTEMBER 2026

UK HR hiring shows early signs of recovery

+2.5%

UK HR job postings, July to September

Indeed Hiring Lab index

+22.4%

New HR postings, July to September

Indeed Hiring Lab

50.9

Permanent placements, September

KPMG and REC index, above 50 means growth

HR postings closed the quarter a little higher after a 10.9% fall in the spring, and permanent placements grew for the first time in nearly four years. Growth is marginal and the wider market is still soft, but the direction has changed.

Read the full update

oakleafpartnership.com/news-views

WAYS OF WORKING

Perm or contracting?

Permanent role

WHAT IT IS

Ongoing employment, with potential for longer term development.

WHAT TO CLARIFY

Responsibilities, benefits and progression.

Interim assignment

WHAT IT IS

A defined role that addresses an immediate need.

WHAT TO CLARIFY

Deliverables, duration, start date and extension terms.

Contract role

WHAT IT IS

Project based or specialist work.

WHAT TO CLARIFY

Scope, rate, duration and IR35 status.

YOUR CV

Make your CV tell the right story

WHAT TO INCLUDE

1. Target role or professional headline
2. Short profile linking your experience to your next step
3. Relevant skills, backed up by examples
4. Work history with achievements and outcomes
5. Education, qualifications and relevant training

FOR EVERY ACHIEVEMENT

What you did
+ the challenge or scope
+ the result

FOR EXAMPLE

Led a new performance framework across a 1,200 person business, lifting completion rates from 60% to 95% in one cycle.

INTERVIEW PREPARATION

Competency based interviews: use STAR

Answer each question with a real example, structured in four steps.

S

Situation

What was happening?

T

Task

What were you responsible for?

A

Action

What did you do?

R

Result

What changed?

Tip Spend most of your answer on the action and the result, and say “I” rather than “we”.

SALARY BENCHMARKING

Know your worth before the conversation

1 Compare like for like

Roles with similar responsibilities, experience and location.

2 Use several current sources

Salary surveys, job postings and recruiter insight.

3 Look at the full package

Bonus, benefits, pension or retirement contributions, leave and contract terms, not only base salary.

4 Know your range

Decide the range and overall package you would consider before the conversation.

WORKING WITH RECRUITERS

How can we help?

A good recruiter is a partner for your whole career, not only your next role.

Talk to us at any stage, even when you are not actively looking.

Market insight

Where hiring demand is, and why.

Salary benchmarking

What your experience is worth today.

CV feedback

Honest advice on your CV and LinkedIn.

Interview preparation

Briefings on the role, people and process.

Access to roles

Opportunities that are not always advertised.

Confidential advice

A sounding board whenever you need one.

LINKEDIN

Get recognised in the market

Make your profile easy to understand

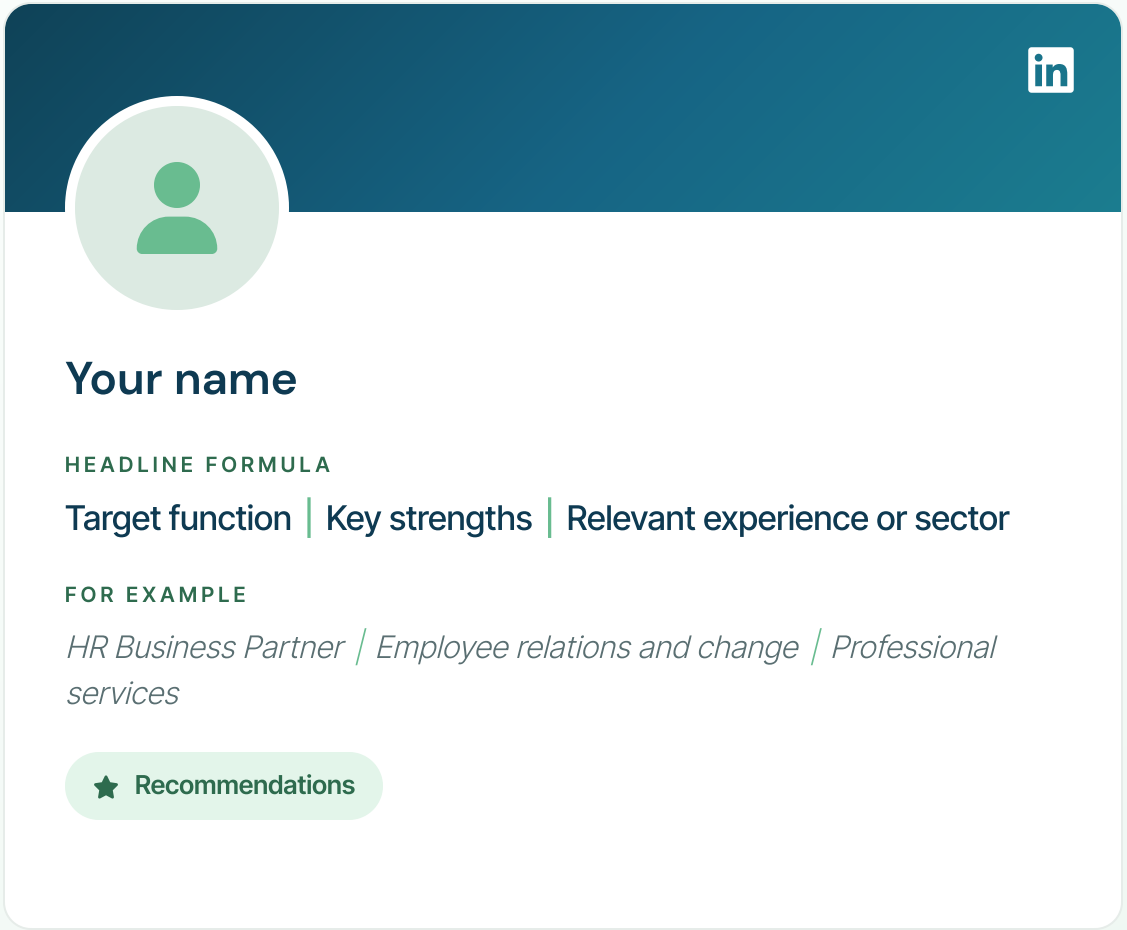
Someone outside your organisation should see what you do in seconds.

Write a clear headline

Use the formula: function, strengths, experience or sector.

Ask for recommendations

A few words from people you have worked with carry real weight.



THANK YOU

Q&A

Let’s keep the conversation going.

Beth Hicks
Director
bethhicks@oakleafpartnership.com
020 7337 7611

Marie Robery-Bliss
Director
marierobery-bliss@oakleafpartnership.com
020 7337 7639